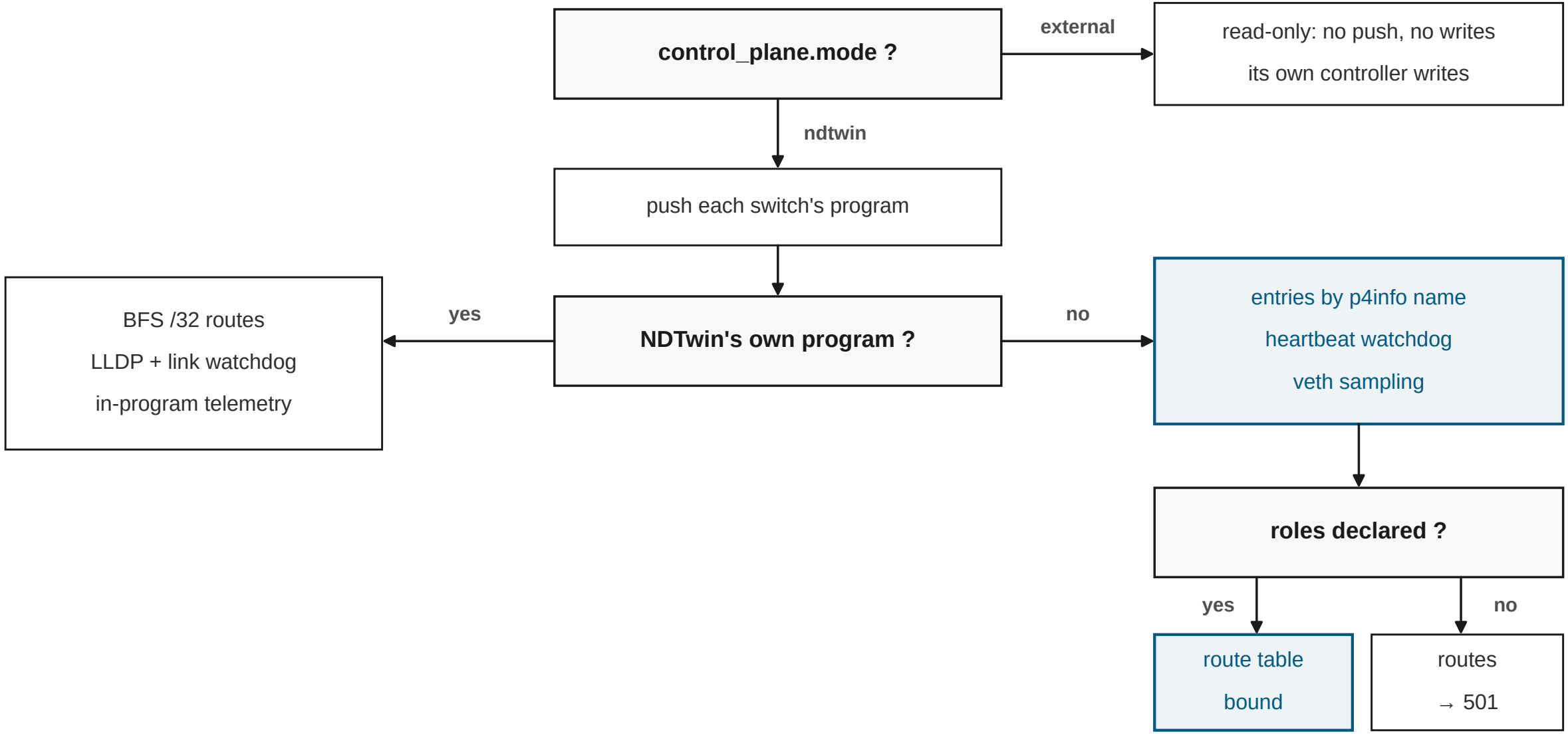What the proxy decides at start-up